

By **Ashish Dhawan & Gouri Gupta**

WHEN **CHATBOTS** AND **CHALK BOARDS** ARE PALS IN THE CLASSROOM

WITH AI TOOLS BEING TESTED IN CLASSROOMS AROUND INDIA, SOLID STANDARDS AND POLICY RESPONSES ARE CRITICAL TO ADVANCE LEARNING AND TEACHING OUTCOMES

Artificial Intelligence in education is no longer a distant idea. It is a rapidly emerging tool that educational institutes are engaging with, reshaping how students learn and teachers teach. From AI tutors and automated assessments to lesson planning and teacher feedback, classrooms across the world are experimenting with the technology at a pace few anticipated even two years ago.

The real question is not whether AI will enter education, but how it will be integrated in equitable ways, how it can improve teaching as well as learning outcomes. For India, this moment is particularly consequential. With large classrooms, diverse learning levels and teacher shortages, the technology presents an opportunity to extend support where human capacity is stretched, provided it is used to strengthen and not sidestep the learning process.

The good news: AI tools in service of that goal are being innovated everywhere, even in low- and middle-income countries. Recent analyses have identified nearly 300 examples globally, with India emerging as one of the most active ecosystems. Though most tools today are for students, supporting theory and practice, a growing share are for teachers who need help making assessment plans and educational material. Relatively few solutions, at the moment, are for systemic decision-making.

An exciting tool, Khanmigo, that teaches through guided questioning rather than answer generation using AI is being piloted in under-resourced parts of India. Developed by Khan Academy in the United States, it has been brought to India through the Central Square Foundation (CSF), with which the authors are involved; it is being adapted to Indian curricula

Illustration by **NILANJAN DAS / AI**